management

ninth edition

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MARY COULTER

Chapter 15 Motivating Employees

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What is Motivation?

- **Motivation** is the inner force that makes people behave in certain ways to satisfy their needs or achieve their goals.
- You study hard because you **want to get good grades** and **make your parents proud**.
  → Your goal (good grades) **motivates** you to study.
- **Motivation** is the process that **energizes**, **directs**, and **sustains** a person's efforts toward achieving a goal.

What Motivation Is *Not*

- It's **not a personality trait**.
  You can't label people as "motivated" or "unmotivated" forever — motivation changes based on the situation.
  For example, you might be **highly motivated** in your favorite subject but **less motivated** in one you find boring.

Three Key Elements of Motivation

- **Energy :**is a measure of intensity, drive, and vigor. A motivated person puts forth effort and works hard. A motivated person puts in **a lot of effort** and energy into their work
- **Direction:** High levels of effort don’t necessarily lead to favorable job performance unless the effort is channeled in a direction that benefits the organization**.** It’s not enough to just work hard — the effort must be **focused in the right direction**, toward goals that matter.
- **Persistence :**Effort directed toward and consistent with organizational goals is the kind of effort we want from employees. Finally, motivation includes a persistence

What Motivates You?

What's important to you or excites you in a job? Some say "money." Others might say "challenging work" or "fun coworkers." If you have a solid grounding in and understanding of what motivates you, it can help you make smart career and job choices.

The following is a list of twelve factors that might enter into your decision in selecting a job. Read over the list. Then rank order the items in terms of importance, with 1 being highest in importance and twelve being lowest in importance.

____ *High pay*
____ *Good working conditions*
____ *Opportunities for growth and new challenges*
____ *Considerate boss*
____ *Inclusion in decisions that affect you*
____ *Fair and equitable treatment*
____ *Job security*
____ *Promotion potential*
____ *Excellent benefits (vacation time, retirement contributions, etc.)*
____ *Freedom and independence*

Now, compare your list with others in your class. How similar were your preferences? It's rare for lists to be exactly the same. This tells us that people differ in terms of what they value. Second, use these results to better understand what you're looking for in a job.

Early Theories of Motivation

- Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs
- MacGregor's Theories X and Y
- Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory

Early Theories of Motivation

- Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs Theory
  - Needs were categorized as five levels of lower- to higher-order needs.
    - Individuals must satisfy lower-order needs before they can satisfy higher order needs.
    - Satisfied needs will no longer motivate.
    - Motivating a person depends on knowing at what level that person is on the hierarchy.
  - Hierarchy of needs
    - Lower-order (external): physiological, safety
    - Higher-order (internal): social, esteem, self-actualization

Exhibit 16–1 Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs

Maslow’s Hierarchy of Needs Theory

The best-known theory of motivation is probably Abraham Maslow’s **hierarchy of needs theory**.[5] Maslow was a psychologist who proposed that within every person is a hierarchy of five needs:

1. Physiological needs: A person’s needs for food, drink, shelter, and other physical requirements.

2. Safety needs: A person’s needs for security and protection from physical and emotional harm as well as assurance that physical needs will continue to be met.

3. Social needs: A person’s needs for affection, belongingness, acceptance, and friendship.

4. Esteem needs: A person’s needs for internal esteem factors

Scenario: An Employee’s Journey in a Company
Example:
Maria just joined a manufacturing company as a production assistant.
1.Physiological Needs:
At first, Maria focuses on earning enough money to cover her **basic needs**—food, rent, and transportation. Her salary allows her to afford daily necessities.
2.Safety Needs:
After a few months, Maria becomes concerned about **job security** and workplace safety. She feels motivated when the company provides **health insurance, a safe work environment, and a stable contract**.
3.Social Needs:
Once she feels secure, Maria seeks **belonging and friendship** at work. She joins a company sports team and builds good relationships with her co-workers, making her feel like part of the team.
4.Esteem Needs:
Maria starts wanting **recognition and respect**. She works hard, earns a promotion to supervisor, and receives praise from her manager, which boosts her confidence and sense of achievement.
5.Self-Actualization Needs:
Finally, Maria wants to **reach her full potential**. She enrolls in management training, sets goals to become a plant manager, and mentors new employees—

Early Theories of Motivation (cont'd)

- McGregor's Theory X and Theory Y
  - Theory X
    - Assumes that workers have little ambition, dislike work, avoid responsibility, and require close supervision.
  - Theory Y
    - Assumes that workers can exercise self-direction, desire responsibility, and like to work.
  - Assumption:
    - Motivation is maximized by participative decision making, interesting jobs, and good group relations.

Example Scenario:

Company A (Theory X Manager):

Mr. Cruz manages a call center. He believes that his team members are lazy and will slack off if not watched. He sets **strict rules**, **monitors calls constantly**, and gives **little freedom** to make decisions.

Employees feel stressed and only work hard to **avoid punishment**, not because they are motivated.

→ This is **Theory X** in action.

Company B (Theory Y Manager):

Ms. Santos manages a marketing team. She believes her team members are capable and enjoy challenges.

She encourages them to **share ideas**, **make decisions** about campaigns, and **take responsibility** for results.

The team feels **trusted and valued**, becomes more creative, and produces high-quality work.

→ This is **Theory Y** in action.

- Herzberg's Motivation-Hygiene Theory
  - Job satisfaction and job dissatisfaction are created by different factors.
    - **Hygiene factors:** extrinsic (environmental) factors that create job dissatisfaction.
    - **Motivators:** intrinsic (psychological) factors that create job satisfaction.
  - Attempted to explain why job satisfaction does not result in increased performance.
    - The opposite of satisfaction is not dissatisfaction, but rather no satisfaction.

Exhibit 16–2 Herzberg's Motivation-Hygiene Theory

Motivators	Hygiene Factors
• Achievement • Recognition • Work Itself • Responsibility • Advancement • Growth	• Supervision • Company Policy • Relationship with Supervisor • Working Conditions • Salary • Relationship with Peers • Personal Life • Relationship with Subordinates • Status • Security
Extremely Satisfied	Extremely Dissatisfied

Neutral

Frederick Herzberg said that there are **two kinds of factors** that affect how people feel about their jobs:

1. **Motivators (Intrinsic Factors)** – These are things **inside the job** that make people feel **happy and satisfied**.
    1. Examples: **Achievement, recognition, responsibility, growth, and the work itself.**
    2. These things **motivate** people to work better and enjoy their jobs.
2. **Hygiene Factors (Extrinsic Factors)** – These are things **outside the job** that can make people **unhappy** if they are not good, but they don’t really motivate people when they are good.
    1. Examples: **Salary, company policies, supervision, working conditions, and relationships with co-workers.**
    2. If these are missing or bad → people become **dissatisfied**.

Motivation and Needs

- Three-Needs Theory (McClelland)
  - There are three major acquired needs that are major motives in work.
    - **Need for achievement (nAch)**
      - The drive to excel and succeed
    - **Need for power (nPow)**
      - The need to influence the behavior of others
    - **Need of affiliation (nAff)**
      - The desire for interpersonal relationships

Three-Needs Theory

- David McClelland said that people are motivated by **three main needs** that they **learn** through life (not born with). These are:

1. **Need for Achievement (nAch)** – The desire to **do things better**, **reach goals**, and **succeed**.
    1. People with a high need for achievement want to **solve problems**, **take responsibility**, and **see quick results**.
    2. They like tasks that are **challenging but possible** — not too easy, not too hard.
2. **Need for Power (nPow)** – The desire to **influence or control others** and **make an impact**.
    1. People with a high need for power like to **lead**, **persuade**, and **make decisions** that affect others.
    2. Good managers usually have this need — they enjoy guiding and motivating others.
3. **Need for Affiliation (nAff)** – The desire to have **friendly and close relationships** with others.
    1. People with a high need for affiliation want to **be liked**, **work in teams**, and **avoid conflict**.
    2. They feel happiest when they have good relationships at work.

Scenario: A team of three employees

•**Ana** loves setting goals, taking on challenging projects, and getting feedback about her performance. She feels proud when she completes tasks successfully.

→ She has a **high need for achievement (nAch).**

•**Ben** enjoys being in charge of meetings and making decisions for the group. He likes when others follow his ideas.

→ He has a **high need for power (nPow).**

•**Cathy** values teamwork and harmony. She likes when everyone gets along and feels uncomfortable with conflict.

→ She has a **high need for affiliation (nAff).**

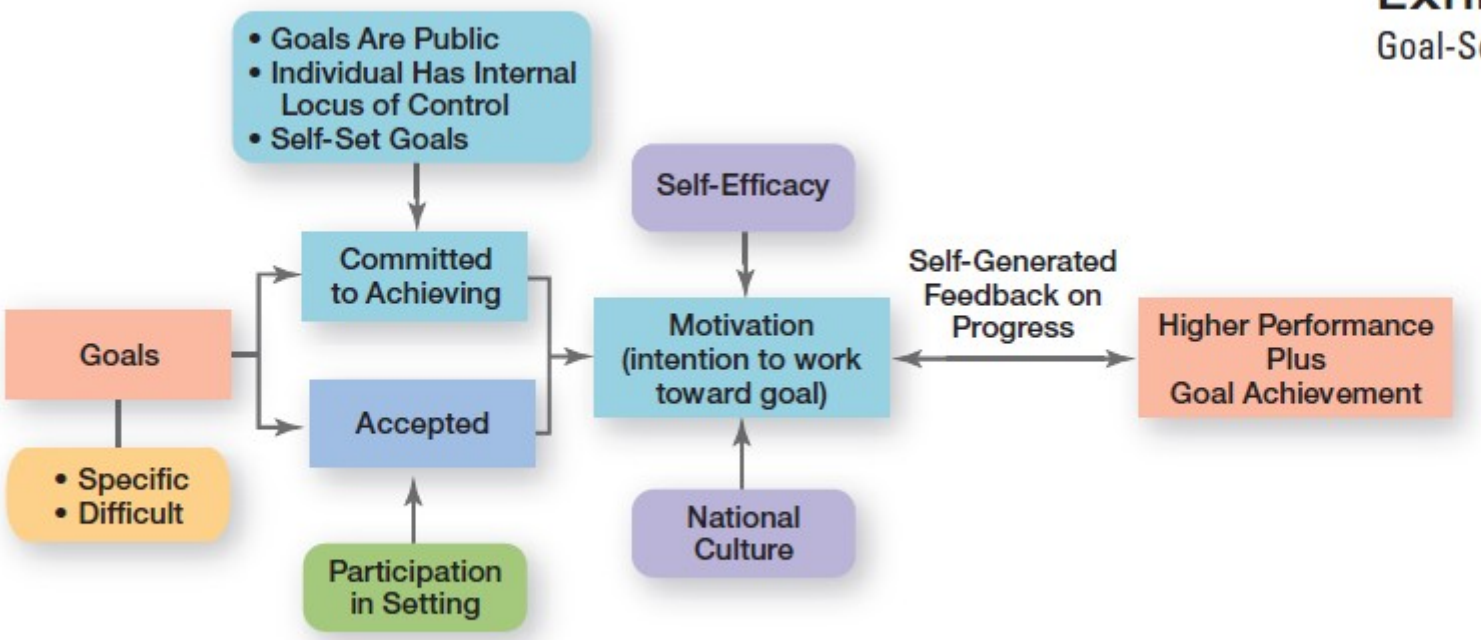
CONTEMPORARY **theories of motivation**

- **Goal-setting theory:**

“The proposition that specific goals increase performance and that difficult goals, when accepted, result in higher performance than do easy goals”

- **Goal-Setting Theory** explains that people are more motivated and perform better when they have **clear, specific, and challenging goals**, instead of vague ones like “do your best.”
- When people know **exactly what they need to achieve** and **believe they can reach it**, they are more focused, work harder, and accomplish more.

Exhibit 16-5
Goal-Setting Theory



💡 Main Ideas of Goal-Setting Theory:

1. **Specific Goals Work Better Than Vague Ones**
   1. A clear goal tells you *exactly* what to do.
2. **Challenging Goals Motivate More Than Easy Ones**
   1. People feel more excited and determined when goals are difficult (but possible) to reach.
   2. However, goals only work if people **accept** them and are **committed** to achieving them.
3. **Feedback Is Important**
   1. People need to know **how well they're doing** so they can adjust and improve.
   2. Feedback can come from a manager or from self-checking progress.
   3. **Self-feedback** (when you track your own progress) often motivates people even more.
4. **Goal Commitment Matters**

   People are more likely to work hard toward goals when they truly **believe in them**, especially when:

   - The goal is made **public** (others know about it).
   - The person feels **in control** of their success.
   - The person **set the goal themselves** (not just assigned by a boss).
   -

Self-Efficacy (Confidence in Yourself): self-efficacy :**An individual's belief that he or she is capable of performing a task**

1. This means believing in your ability to succeed.
2. If you have **high self-efficacy**, you'll work harder when things get tough.
3. If you have **low self-efficacy**, you might give up easily.

5. **Cultural Differences**
   1. Goal-setting works best in cultures (like North America) where people are encouraged to take initiative, accept challenges, and value performance.
   2. In cultures where people avoid risks or rely heavily on authority, goal-setting might not be

🧩 **Example:**

Scenario: A Sales Team

•The manager tells the sales team: “Try to do your best this month.”

→ This is vague. Employees don’t know what “best” means, so motivation might be low.

•The manager instead says: “Your goal is to make **8 sales calls every day** and reach **50 new customers by the end of the month**.”

→ This is **specific and challenging**, so employees know exactly what to aim for.

•Throughout the month, the team gets **feedback** about their progress. They can see who’s on track and who needs to improve.

•Those who **believe they can do it (high self-efficacy)** work even harder, while others might need encouragement.

Result:

Reinforcement Theory

- **Reinforcement theory:**
  "The theory that behavior is a function of its consequences"
- **Reinforcers**:

Consequences immediately following a behavior, which increase the probability that the behavior will be repeated

- **Reinforcement Theory** says that people's behavior is controlled by its **consequences** — what happens **after** they do something.
- If a behavior is **rewarded**, people are **more likely to do it again**.
- If a behavior is **ignored or punished**, people are **less likely to repeat it**.
- This theory focuses on **actions and results**, not on feelings, goals, or needs.

🧩 **Example 1: At Work**

Situation:

A manager wants employees to come to work on time.

•When an employee **arrives early**, the manager **praises** them and gives a small **reward** (like a bonus or recognition).

→ This is **positive reinforcement**.

→ The employee will likely **keep coming early** to get more rewards.

•If an employee is **late** and the manager **ignores** it (no attention or reward), the behavior may **fade away** because it isn't reinforced.

•If the manager **punishes** the employee (like scolding or deducting pay), the employee might stop being late — but it could also cause **negative side effects** (stress, resentment, or quitting).

Designing Motivating Jobs

Job Design

- The way into which tasks can be combined to form complete jobs.
- Factors influencing job design:
  - Changing organizational environment/structure
  - The organization's technology
  - Employees' skill, abilities, and preferences

Job scope

The number of different tasks required in a job and the frequency with which those tasks are repeated.

Ad

- Job enlargement
  - Horizontal expansion of job. Increasing the scope (number of tasks) in a job.

For instance, a dental hygienist's job could be enlarged so that in addition to cleaning teeth, he or she is pulling patients' files, refiling them when finished, and sanitizing and storing instruments. This type of job design option is called **job enlargement**.

- Job enrichment
  - Vertical expansion of job. Increasing responsibility and autonomy (depth) in a job.

Job enrichment cont….

- Increases **job depth**, which is the degree of control employees have over their work. In other words, employees are empowered to assume some of the tasks typically done by their managers.
- **It** allows workers to do an entire activity with increased freedom, independence, and responsibility. workers get feedback so they can assess and correct their own performance.
- For instance, if our dental hygienist had an enriched job, he or she could, in addition to cleaning teeth, schedule appointments (planning) and follow up with clients (evaluating).

Designing Motivating Jobs (cont'd)

Job Characteristics Model (JCM)

- A conceptual framework for designing motivating jobs that create meaningful work experiences that satisfy employees' growth needs.
- Five primary job characteristics:
  - **Skill variety:** how many skills and talents are needed?
  - **Task identity:** does the job produce a complete work?
  - **Task significance:** how important is the job?
  - **Autonomy:** how much independence does the jobholder have?
  - **Feedback:** do workers know how well they are doing?

Job Characteristics Model

The JCM provides specific guidance to managers for job design. These suggestions specify the types of changes most likely to lead to improvement in the five core 'job dimensions.

1. *Combine tasks*. Put fragmented tasks back together to form a new, larger work module (job enlargement) to increase skill variety and task identity.

2. *Create natural work units*. Design tasks that form an identifiable and meaningful whole to increase employee “ownership” of the work. Encourage employees to view their work as meaningful and important rather than as irrelevant and boring.

3. *Establish client (external or internal) relationships.* Whenever possible, establish direct relationships between workers and their clients to increase skill variety, autonomy, and feedback.

4. *Expand jobs vertically*. Vertical expansion gives employees responsibilities and controls that were formerly reserved for managers, which can increase employee autonomy.

5. *Open feedback channels*. Direct feedback lets employees know how well they’re performing their jobs and whether their performance is improving or not.

Motivation and Perception

Equity Theory

The theory that an employee compares his or her job's input–outcomes ratio with that of relevant others and then corrects any inequity.

- If the ratios are perceived as equal then a state of equity (fairness) exists.
- If the ratios are perceived as unequal, inequity exists and the person feels under- or over-rewarded.
- When inequities occur, employees will attempt to do something to rebalance the ratios (seek justice).

For example:

- If someone offered you $80,000 a year on your first job after graduating from college,

you'd probably jump at the offer and report to work enthusiastic, ready to tackle
whatever needed to be done, and certainly be satisfied with your pay. How would you
react, though, if you found out a month into the job that a coworker—another recent
graduate, your age, with comparable grades from a comparable school, and with
comparable work experience—was getting $85,000 a year? You'd probably be upset!
Even though in absolute terms, $80,000 is a lot of money for a new graduate to make
(and you know it!), that suddenly isn't the issue. Now you see the issue as
what you believe is *fair*—what is *equitable.*

- The term *equity* is related to the concept of fairness and equitable

Equity Theory

Perceived Ratio Comparison[a]	*Employee's Assessment*
$\frac{\text{Outcomes A}}{\text{Inputs A}} < \frac{\text{Outcomes B}}{\text{Inputs B}}$	Inequity (underrewarded)
$\frac{\text{Outcomes A}}{\text{Inputs A}} = \frac{\text{Outcomes B}}{\text{Inputs B}}$	Equity
$\frac{\text{Outcomes A}}{\text{Inputs A}} > \frac{\text{Outcomes B}}{\text{Inputs B}}$	Inequity (overrewarded)

Motivation and Perception (cont'd)

Equity Theory focused on:

- Distributive justice
  - The perceived fairness of the amount and allocation of rewards among individuals (i.e., who received what).
    - Influences an employee's satisfaction.

Procedural justice

- Perceived fairness of the process used to determine the distribution of rewards

Expectancy Theory

- States that an individual tends to act in a certain way based on the expectation that the act will be followed by a given outcome and on the attractiveness of that outcome to the individual.
- Key to the theory is understanding and managing employee goals and the linkages among and between effort, performance and rewards.
  - **Effort:** employee abilities and training/development
  - **Performance:** valid appraisal systems
  - **Rewards (goals):** understanding employee needs

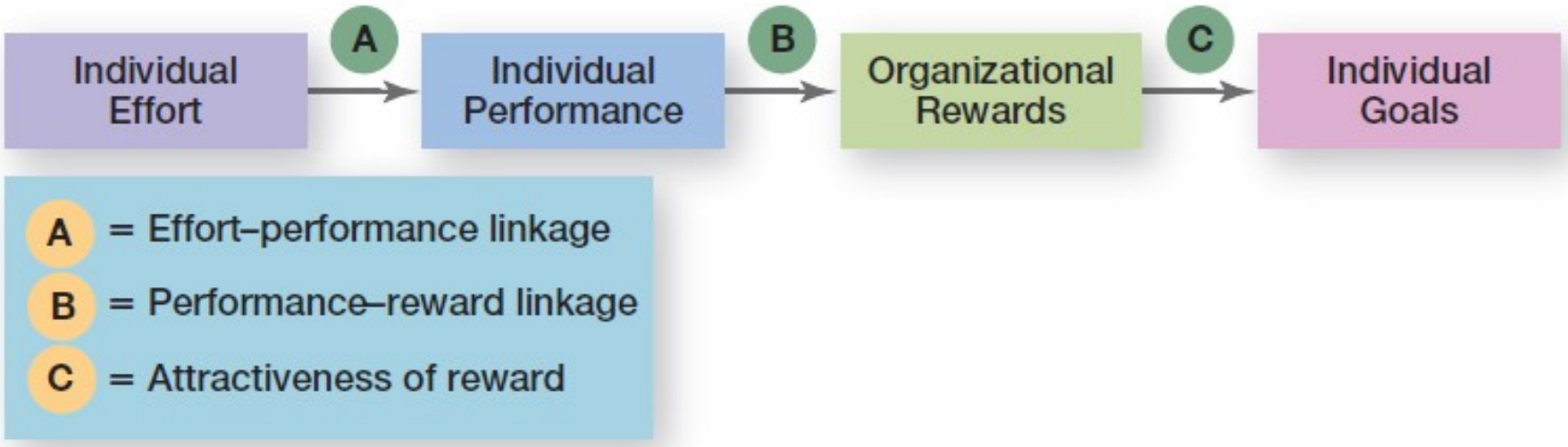
Expectancy Theory

Expectancy theory states that an individual tends to act in a certain way based on
the expectation that the act will be followed by a given outcome and on the attractiveness
of that outcome to the individual. It includes three variables or relationships (see
Exhibit 16-8):

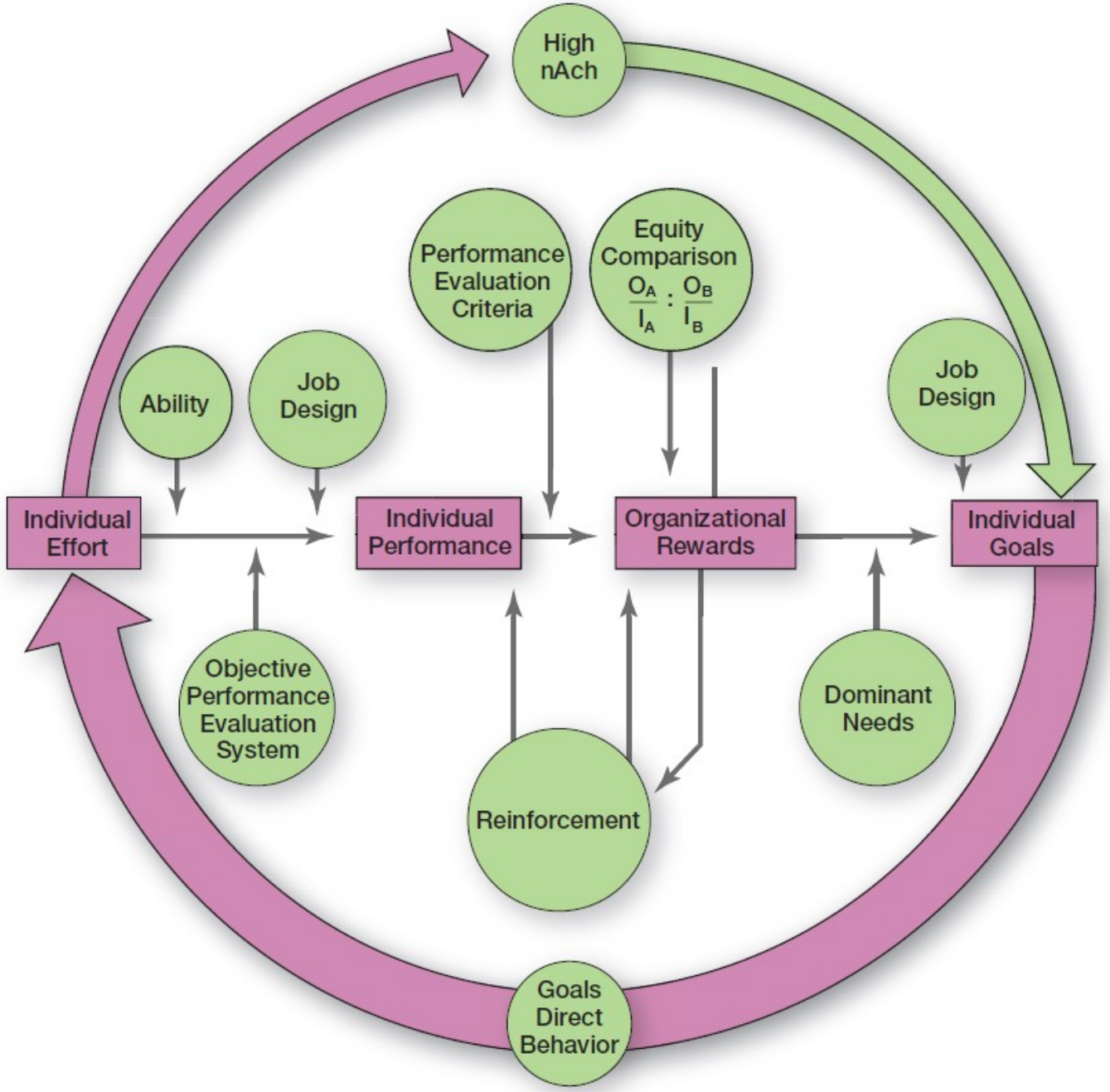
1. *Effort-performance linkage*: the probability perceived by the individual that
exerting a given amount of effort will lead to a certain level of performance.

2. *Performance-reward linkage*: the degree to which the individual believes that
performing at a particular level is instrumental in attaining the desired outcome.

3. *Attractiveness*: the importance an individual places on the


Individual Effort
A
Individual Performance
B
Organizational Rewards
C
Individual Goals
A = Effort–performance linkage
B = Performance–reward linkage
C = Attractiveness of reward

Integrating Contemporary Theories of Motivation



Integrated Individual Motivation Process

1. Individual Goals

- Motivation starts with **individual goals**, which come from personal **dominant needs** (e.g., need for achievement, recognition, security).
- **Job design** also influences what goals individuals form — a well-designed job can make goals clearer and more motivating.

2. Goals Direct Behavior

- Once goals are set, they **direct behavior** — meaning they influence how and where the individual puts in effort.

3. Individual Effort

- The amount of **effort** an individual exerts depends on how motivated they are to reach those goals.
- **Ability** (skills, knowledge, experience) and **job design** affect how effectively that effort translates into performance.
- **Objective performance evaluation systems** ensure fair measurement of performance outcomes.

4. Individual Performance

- When effort is applied, **individual performance** results.
- This performance is evaluated based on **performance evaluation criteria** — which define what counts as success.

5. Organizational Rewards

- Based on performance, individuals receive **organizational rewards** (e.g., pay, promotions, recognition).
- These rewards feed back into the motivation system in multiple ways:
  - **Reinforcement:** Positive rewards strengthen the likelihood of repeating good performance.
  - **Equity Comparison:** Individuals compare their rewards to others' (using the formula OAIA=OBIB\frac{O_A}{I_A} = \frac{O_B}{I_B}IA OA=IBOB) to assess fairness.
    - *O = Outcomes (rewards), I = Inputs (effort/performance)*
  - **High nAch (Need for Achievement):** People with a high need for achievement respond strongly to rewards tied to performance.

- **6. Feedback Loop**
- Rewards and evaluations influence **future goals** and **effort**:
  - If rewards are perceived as fair and satisfying, motivation increases.
  - If perceived as unfair, motivation and effort may decrease.
- The large circular arrows represent this **continuous feedback process** — motivation, effort, performance, and rewards feed back into each other over time.
- **Summary of Flow:**

1. **Needs + Job Design → Goals**
2. **Goals → Effort**
3. **Effort + Ability + Evaluation → Performance**
4. **Performance → Rewards**
5. **Rewards → Reinforcement + Equity + Future Goals**